WHO STANDARD PROCEDURES

ACCIDENT/INJURY/INCIDENT & HAZARD REPORTING & INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE

Date Adopted: 5 February 2004
Date Amended: 2007, 2012 & April 2013
Responsible Officer: Risk Management Coordinator

INTRODUCTION

This procedure outlines the requirements for the reporting and investigation of incidents that occur at City of Armadale. It also outlines the requirements for the statutory reporting of notifiable work-related injuries and dangerous occurrences, a mandatory requirement under the Occupational Safety and Health legislation and an insurance requirement.

Incident and accident reports are valuable because:

- They capture complaints, incidents and accidents before they become claims.
- They serve as the basis for analysing the causes of incidents and accidents and for recommending risk improvements to prevent similar events in the future.
- They help identify weaknesses in the current risk management policies and procedures to prevent more serious losses from occurring.
- They help establish a defence for claims that may be presented years after an incident/accident.

Staff are responsible for immediately reporting all hazards, incidents and injuries to their manager as per the Accident/Injury/Incident & Hazard Reporting procedure. If their manager is not available they must advise the next senior manager. All reports must be supported in writing using the Accident/Incident & Hazard Reporting Form.

1. DEFINITIONS

Accident	An accident is a mishap that causes injury to a worker or an injury caused to another person by a worker. An accident does not necessarily need to lead to time off work or visit to a doctor, but can include cuts, burns strains, sprains etc
Corrective Action	Is an action taken after an incident to correct the problem and to reduce the risk of a similar incident occurring
Hazard	A hazard is anything or any condition that causes or has the potential to cause injury, harm or ill heath.

Incident	An incident is a mishap outside the normal that does not lead to personal injury. For example damage to equipment or property.
Investigation	An investigation is a systematic examination of the event/incidents and its cause /contribution factors
Work Injury	Any injury, occupational disease or disability which arises out of or in the course of any City of Armadale sponsored activity and which requires first-aid or medical treatment.

2. RESPONSIBILITIES

Employees

- Will immediately or as soon as practicable report any incident or accident to their immediate supervisor or manager and seek first aid treatment for nay injuries or suspected injuries.
- Ensure the completion of Accident/Injury/Incident & Hazard Report Form.

Management

- Direct Supervisor must investigate all reported Accident/Injuries/Incidents & Hazards
- Ensure corrective action is taken to prevent recurrence
- Scan and forward all appropriate documentation to the Risk Management Co-ordinator in a timely fashion.

Visitors, volunteers and contractors

- Visitors, volunteers and contractors should use the accident reporting procedures relevant to staff in their location.

Risk Management Coordinator

- Review all Accident/Injury/Incident & Hazard Report forms
- Ensure completion of Accident/Injury/Incident & Hazard Report Forms in a timely fashion
- Provide feedback, advice and support to direct supervisors
- Provide guidance and assistance to direct supervisors to prevent a recurrence of the same or similar Accident/Injury/Incident & Hazards
- Monitor the investigation process and control strategies implemented
- Ensure timely notification to Worksafe as required

3. PROCEDURES

3.1 Reporting

An accident may involve injury to a staff member or other person, damage to equipment or buildings or both. It may include fire, electrical, spillage, equipment or journey accidents during the course of the working day.

- If an injury is incurred then treatment should be obtained from the staff member's own doctor, unless treatment is required immediately from a First Aider. The first aider must record details of minor injuries in the first aid book.

Other nearby Medical Centres available are:

Champion Drive Medical Centre, 273 Railway Parade, Tel: 9399 5399
Forrest Road GP, 50 Forrest Road, Armadale, Tel 9497 1900:
Church Ave, Medical Centre, Armadale Tel 9497 2772
Kelvale Medical Group, 53 Railway Ave, Kelmscott, Tel 9495 1230
Seville Drive, Medical Centre, Seville Grove, Tel: 9498 1099

In case of serious injury/illness phone an ambulance

- If a doctor is consulted the staff member must advise the Doctor that the injury is work related and obtain a Workers Compensation First Medical Certificate from the doctor. The staff member must then lodge a Workers Compensation Claim.

- All accidents and incidents must be immediately reported orally to the supervisor of the staff member concerned and to the area Safety and Health Representative.

- The **person involved** in the accident **must** complete an "Hazard **/ Incident / Accident Report Form"** as soon as practicable and forward it on to their supervisor who completes the section at the back of the form (Page 2).

  The **Accident/Injury/Incident & Hazard Report Form** is available on the Intranet under "OSH Forms"

- Where, due to the accident, the person concerned is unable to complete an "Accident/Injury/Incident & Hazard Report Form" then arrangements must be made for their supervisor to complete the form. These forms must be completed no later than **24 hours** after the accident/incident.

- The completed form must be forwarded to the supervisor concerned who undertakes an investigation of the accident/incident and completes the section at the back of the form. The supervisor may suggest alternative measures which could prevent a similar accident occurring in the future.

- If the **supervisor** is absent from work the staff member must forward the form directly to the Manager.

- If the accident investigation identifies that the corrective action is beyond the authority or resources of the supervisor, the supervisor must inform the Manager as soon as possible and assist the Manager in the implementation of interim corrective procedures.

- **NOTE: The hazards identified in the investigation process must not be allowed to remain without attention, while the proposed action is pending.**

- Once supervisor has received the form they are to ensure that it is scanned and emailed to the Risk Management Coordinator.

- The original should be forwarded to the Manager for their attention and then onto the Risk Management Coordinator for completion of the process.

- The City of Armadale is required to notify WorkSafe of work place injuries that result in

i. A death
ii. A fracture of the skull, spine or pelvis.
iii. A fracture of any bone in the arm, other than in the wrists or hand, or in the leg, other than a bone in the ankle or foot.
iv. An amputation of an arm, a hand, finger, finger joint, leg, foot, toe or toe joint.
v. The loss of sight of an eye.
vi. Any injury other than those referred to above which, in the opinion of a medical practitioner, is likely to prevent the employee from being able to work within 10 days of the day on which the injury occurred.

Types of diseases that must be reported

Infectious diseases: tuberculosis, viral hepatitis, legionnaire's disease and HIV where these diseases are contracted during work involving exposure to human blood products, body secretions, excretions or other material which may be a source of infection.

Occupational zoonoses: Q fever, anthrax, leptospiroses and brucellosis where these diseases are contracted during work involving the handling of, or contact with, animals, animal hides, skins, wool, hair, carcases or animal waste products.

- Where an accident occurs which involves only damage to equipment, plant or a building, immediate notification, for insurance purposes must be given to the Government & Administration Officer (Ext602). Such accidents must also be reported to the Risk Management Co-ordinator as noted above.

- If an injury has occurred that has resulted in 3 or more days off work then the Risk Management Co-ordinator **must** be advised.

Under no circumstances may staff discuss details on any accident or incident with the Press or TV Media, without the express permission of their Executive Director or the Chief Executive Officer.

4. ACCIDENT/INJURY/INCIDENT & HAZARD INVESTIGATION

Ensure the injured person has received appropriate treatment and the scene is made safe.

Serious harm/injury, major emergencies and fatal accidents must be immediately reported to the Executive Director and to contact the Risk Management Co-ordinator.

If the accident has resulted in serious harm/injury, the accident scene must not be disturbed other than to provide assistance or make safe until the appropriate authorities arrive.

All contact with the media shall be through the Executive Director and/or the Chief Executive Officer.

Investigate properly all concerns, threats, building related hazards, physical hazard, incidents, accidents or non-conformances reported to you verbally or in writing.

All accidents/incidents shall be investigated in accordance with the guidelines in the Accident/Injury/Incident & Hazard Report Form.

5. RISK MANAGEMENT CO-ORDINATOR

The RMC will monitor trends of accidents/incidents and initiate further investigation where:

- A number of incidents are noted for similar situations
- A workers compensation claim has been lodged
- The manager has requested assistance to investigate an accident/incident
- A serious or major incident has occurred
- A situation is deemed to require further investigation

6. CORRECTIVE ACTION

The scope and impact of any corrective action taken shall be appropriate to the magnitude and potential for harm of the accident/incident or hazard.

7. RECORDS

Records of all accidents/incidents notification, reporting, investigation and corrective actions shall be kept. Where applicable, records shall be kept for duration as required by legislation.

8. OTHER DOCUMENTATION

Accident/Injury/Incident & Hazard Report Form
Accident/Injury/Incident & Hazard Investigation Report Guidelines
Workers Compensation & Rehabilitation Questions & Answers
Flowchart – What to do when an injury has occurred
Flowchart - Injury Management - for a Work Related Injury or illness

ACCIDENT/INJURY/INCIDENT/HAZARD REPORTING AND INVESTIGATION FLOWCHART

